

27/03/2023 — 2 hours — Optimization and Operational Research

- Calculator are allowed
- Provide all the calculation details

PART 1 - Convexity

Study the convexity of the following functions

Question 1—

$$f(x, y) = -\log\left(\frac{1}{4x + y}\right), \quad f(x, y) = \exp(x - 2y) - x \quad \text{and} \quad f(x, y, z) = 2x^2 + 2xy + 2y^2 + z^2$$

Question 2—A function is convex if its restriction to every line is convex. For a function $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, f is convex if $g(t) = f(z + tv)$ is convex with $t \in \mathbb{R}$ for all $z, v \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Use this property to study the convexity of

$$f(x, y) = \frac{x^2}{a^2} + \frac{y^2}{b^2}$$

PART 2 - Unconstrained Optimization

$$\arg \min_x f(x) = ax_1^2 + 2x_1x_2 + x_2^2$$

Question 3—Provide the gradient of f in the form (i.e. explicit the value of B) :

$$\nabla_x f(x) = Bx$$

Question 4—For which value of a is the function f convex ?

Question 5—Apply the gradient descent algorithm with optimal step for $a = 2$ to minimize f starting at $(2, 1)$, with

PART 3 - Constrained Optimization

$$g_\eta(x) = \eta x_1^3 + \frac{1}{2}(2x_1^2 + x_2^2 + x_1x_2) - 6x_1 + 2x_2$$

Question 6—Study the convexity of $g : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, which is parameterized by a value $\eta \in \mathbb{R}$.

Question 7—give the solution of Euler's equations for all value of $\eta \notin \{-2\sqrt{2}, 2\sqrt{2}\}$. What happens when $\eta = -2\sqrt{2}$ or $\eta = 2\sqrt{2}$

Question 8—Give the nature of the previous extrema (i.e. say if it is local/global minimum/maximum of the function). The nature of the extremum depends on η

PART 4 - Constrained Optimization

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_x f(x) &= 2x^2 - 4x - 2 \\ \text{s.t.} \quad &-4x \leq -2 \end{aligned}$$

Question 9—Write the Lagrangian of this problem.

Question 10—What is the dual function ? Deduce the lower bound of the optimum.

Question 11—Does strong duality holds ? Prove it if needed.

Question 12—Find the optimal values with respect to KKT conditions